

# Third Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Tertia Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: the endangered sinner sought, strengthened, and welcomed into joy

| Proper               | TLM text / reference                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Scriptural axis                       | Connection                                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Introit</b>       | <i>Respice in me, et miserere mei; Ad te, Domine, levavi animam meam</i> (Ps. 24:1–2, 16, 18)                                                                                                                                           | Solitude, poverty, mercy              | The worshipper enters neither self-sufficient nor hidden: affliction and sin are placed under God's merciful gaze.                                                         |
| <b>Collect</b>       | <i>Protector in te sperantium, Deus</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Providence and pilgrimage             | God's mercy supplies what is neither strong nor holy without him and orders temporal goods toward eternity.                                                                |
| <b>Epistle</b>       | 1 Pet. 5:6–11                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Humility, trust, vigilance            | Casting care on God and resisting the devil are one movement of humble, active faith.                                                                                      |
| <b>Gradual</b>       | <i>Iacta cogitatum tuum in Domino</i> (Ps. 54:23, 17, 19)                                                                                                                                                                               | Entrusted anxiety and deliverance     | Before the Gospel, the congregation practices entrusting the anxiety that makes isolation and despair attractive.                                                          |
| <b>Alleluia</b>      | <i>Deus iudex iustus, fortis et pateriens</i> (Ps. 7:12)                                                                                                                                                                                | Justice, strength, patience           | Divine patience opens the Gospel's mercy without denying judgment.                                                                                                         |
| <b>Gospel</b>        | Luke 15:1–10                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Sheep, drachma, repentance, joy       | Christ answers proud murmuring by revealing the search for sinners and heaven's joy at their repentance.                                                                   |
| <b>Offertory</b>     | <i>Speret in te omnes</i> (Ps. 9:11–13)                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Trust and the poor man's prayer       | The found sinner becomes an offering Church that trusts, seeks, praises, and remembers the afflicted.                                                                      |
| <b>Secret</b>        | <i>Respice, Domine, munera supplicantis Ecclesiae ... et saluti credentium perpetua sanctificatione sumenda concede</i>                                                                                                                 | The Church's gifts and sanctification | The God whose merciful gaze seeks the lost is asked to look upon the Church's gifts and grant that continual sanctification make them serve the salvation of the faithful. |
| <b>Communion</b>     | <i>Gaudium est Angelis Dei</i> (Luke 15:10)                                                                                                                                                                                             | Joy over repentance                   | The antiphon celebrates repentant restoration; Eucharistic joy does not erase the call to conversion or proper reception.                                                  |
| <b>Postcommunion</b> | <i>Sancta tua nos, Domine, sumpta vivificent</i>                                                                                                                                                                                        | Vivification and lasting mercy        | The holy things received give life and prepare the purified faithful for everlasting mercy.                                                                                |
| Sense                | Synthesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                       |                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Literal</b>       | Jesus receives publicans and sinners and answers the Pharisees' and scribes' murmuring with a shepherd and a woman who seek until they find; Peter commands humility, the casting of care on God, vigilance, and resistance in faith.   |                                       |                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Allegorical</b>   | Gregory reads the Shepherd as Christ bearing fallen humanity, and the woman and lamp as divine Wisdom manifested in the flesh to restore the Creator's likeness in man. The Church proclaims and sacramentally serves this saving work. |                                       |                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Moral</b>         | Grace takes the initiative, yet the hearer is summoned to repent, humble himself, cast his cares on God, resist the devil, and exchange contempt at another's return for shared joy.                                                    |                                       |                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Anagogical</b>    | The angels' joy and the Postcommunion's everlasting mercy direct present repentance toward the restored heavenly communion of angels and redeemed humanity.                                                                             |                                       |                                                                                                                                                                            |

## In Illo Tempore...

*Canonical order governs; proper rows give traditional composition data under Location and Date, Luke's additional row gives the narrated setting, spanning rows distinguish inherited attribution from historical judgment, and Psalm numbers follow the Vulgate with common modern numbers in parentheses.*

| Proper                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Citation                                      | Location                                        | Date                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>Alleluia</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Ps. 7:12                                      | Judah / Israel; site unrecorded                 | c. 1010 BC                     |
| The Greek and Latin title traditionally makes this David's lament concerning Cush the Benjaminite; older Catholic scholarship places it during Saul's persecution, but neither title nor Scripture identifies the episode or writing site. Pre-royal David addresses God and Israel's worshippers, placing threatened innocence beneath the Judge who searches hearts and peoples. Modern author, date, place, and Cush's identity remain uncertain (Ps. 7 and notes, <i>NABRE</i> ; <i>Catholic Encyclopedia</i> , "Psalms").                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                               |                                                 |                                |
| <b>Offertory</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Ps. 9:11–13                                   | Israel; site unrecorded                         | c. 1000 BC                     |
| The title traditionally attributes the hymn to David but names no life episode or site; Israel at worship is its inherited audience. Personal victory opens into God's judgment of nations, refuge for the poor, and praise in Zion, placing Davidic kingship under universal justice. Greek and Latin join Psalms 9–10 as one acrostic; modern authorship, date, and place remain unknown (Ps. 9 and notes, <i>NABRE</i> ).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                               |                                                 |                                |
| <b>Introit</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Ps. 24:1–2, 16, 18<br>(modern 25:1–2, 16, 18) | Israel; site unrecorded                         | c. 1000 BC                     |
| The title traditionally attributes this acrostic lament to David but records neither site nor episode, so his stage of life cannot responsibly be recovered. He addresses God before worshipping Israel, joining trust, guidance, forgiveness, loneliness, and affliction before the psalm widens to Israel's redemption. Modern scholarship identifies the form but cannot establish author, date, or place (Ps. 25 and notes, <i>NABRE</i> ).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                               |                                                 |                                |
| <b>Gradual</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Ps. 54:17, 19, 23<br>(modern 55:17, 19, 23)   | Israel; site unrecorded                         | c. 1000 BC                     |
| The superscription traditionally calls this maskil David's but supplies no episode or site; his precise life stage is therefore unknown. A betrayed worshipper amid civic violence prays throughout the day and entrusts his burden to God, turning personal crisis into Israel's durable prayer and language later echoed by 1 Peter 5:7. Modern judgment cannot identify the betrayer, city, author, date, or place (Ps. 55 and notes, <i>NABRE</i> ).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                               |                                                 |                                |
| <b>Gospel;<br/>Communion</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Luke 15:1–10                                  | Achaia (present-day Greece)                     | c. AD 60                       |
| <i>Narrated event</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Luke 9:51; 13:22;<br>15:1–10                  | Journey toward Jerusalem; exact site unrecorded | Final ministry,<br>c. AD 28–29 |
| Ancient tradition identifies St. Luke, Antiochene physician and Paul's companion. The row joins an ancient tradition that he wrote in Achaia for Theophilus and other catechized Christians to an early chronology placing the Gospel before Acts, after years in apostolic mission; the modern majority dates it c. AD 80–90 and leaves its city unknown. Luke supplies the Jerusalem-journey frame but no town: there Jesus answers sinners who approach and leaders who murmur by revealing divine search, repentance, and heaven's joy within Israel's salvation extended to the nations (Luke introduction and 15, <i>NABRE</i> ; <i>Catholic Encyclopedia</i> , "Gospel of Saint Luke" and "Chronology"). |                                               |                                                 |                                |
| <b>Epistle</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 1 Pet. 5:6–11                                 | Rome (present-day Italy)                        | c. AD 63–64                    |
| Tradition identifies St. Peter writing through Silvanus from Rome, called Babylon in 5:13, near the end of his apostolic life and before Nero's persecution and Peter's martyrdom. He addresses largely Gentile churches across five provinces of Asia Minor, joining humility, God's care, vigilance, worldwide solidarity in suffering, and promised glory. Modern proposals range from Petrine authorship to a Roman Petrine disciple or circle c. AD 70–90 (1 Peter introduction and 5, <i>NABRE</i> ; <i>Catholic Encyclopedia</i> , "Epistles of Saint Peter").                                                                                                                                           |                                               |                                                 |                                |

# Source-Grounded Synthesis

## Governing thesis: mercy finds, forms, and gathers

The propers disclose neither indulgence without conversion nor vigilance without trust. God's merciful gaze receives confessed need; his care makes humble resistance possible; Christ seeks until the lost is found and calls heaven to rejoice over repentance; the recovered person then enters the Church's praise, offering, sanctification, and hope of everlasting mercy. Divine initiative remains first throughout, while repentance, resistance, offering, and reception remain real human acts.

1. Behold need → 2. Entrust and resist → 3. Seek and restore → 4. Offer and rejoice  
*Introit-Collect* *Epistle-Alleluia* *Gospel* *Offertory-Postcommunion*

*Reading order.* This four-stage sequence is a source-grounded synopsis of the appointed wording and the identified reception below; no cited witness is presented as author of the complete Roman formulary.

## 1. Merciful regard receives truthful need (*Int.*, *Coll.*)

| Appointed claim                      | Decisive witness                                                                                                                             | Boundary                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Affliction is disclosed</b>       | The Introit's Davidic lament asks God to look upon solitude, poverty, labor, and sin; its psalm verse first raises the soul in trust.        | Mercy does not require a fictitious innocence. Need and guilt are brought into God's presence rather than hidden. |
| <b>Dependence becomes pilgrimage</b> | The Collect confesses that nothing is strong or holy without God and asks his rule and guidance through temporal goods toward eternal goods. | Temporal creation is traversed under grace, not despised as though it were evil.                                  |
| <b>Compassion tests justice</b>      | Cyril calls Christ the saving physician; Gregory contrasts true justice, which pities, with false justice, which disdains.                   | Welcome has a medicinal end. Neither Father treats mercy as approval of sin or repentance as unnecessary.         |

## 2. Entrusted care becomes sober resistance (*Ep.*, *Grad.*, *All.*)

| Movement                      | Textual ground                                                                                         | Inherited clarification                                                                                    | Error excluded                                             |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Humble</b>                 | Peter places the faithful beneath God's mighty hand and promised exaltation.                           | The Introit's poor petitioner supplies a truthful posture before power.                                    | Humility is neither self-hatred nor despair.               |
| <b>Entrust</b>                | Peter's command to cast every care on God directly echoes the Gradual's Psalm 54.                      | Augustine says the self and burden are entrusted to the Creator rather than another fragile final support. | Surrender of care is not refusal of responsibility.        |
| <b>Watch and resist</b>       | A real adversary seeks prey; resistance is steadfast in faith and shared with a suffering brotherhood. | God's final verbs are restore, strengthen, and establish.                                                  | Vigilance is neither isolated heroism nor anxious control. |
| <b>Hear patience actively</b> | The Alleluia names the Judge just, strong, and patient.                                                | Tertullian's use of Luke 15 makes divine patience pursuit that seeks and bears the one.                    | Patience does not make judgment absent or mercy inert.     |

### 3. Search restores without bypassing repentance (*Gosp.*)

| Witness              | Searcher and lost                                                                               | Saving movement                                                                                           | Control                                                                                             |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| St. Cyril            | Christ receives sinners who approach while accusers make mercy itself an accusation.            | The physician uses nearness and table fellowship for healing, repentance, and joy.                        | Christ does not participate in their disorder; welcome has conversion as its end.                   |
| St. Gregory          | The Shepherd bears fallen humanity, and divine Wisdom lights and sweeps for the obscured image. | Incarnation searches; the shoulders bear; conscience is exposed; heaven rejoices.                         | The one and ninety-nine are theological figures, not demographic arithmetic.                        |
| St. Ambrose          | The shoulders become the Cross; the woman can signify the Church seeking the sovereign's coin.  | Humanity lost in Adam is gathered in Christ, and ecclesial proclamation searches for the King's likeness. | Personal repentance belongs within common restoration; neither is erased by the other.              |
| St. Gregory of Nyssa | The lamp becomes illumined reason and the house the interior life.                              | Ascetical self-search uncovers a royal image obscured, not annihilated, by disorder.                      | This is reuse of the parable, not Luke's narrated subject or Gregory the Great's identical reading. |

#### The two parables protect two truths

The sheep prevents salvation from becoming autonomous introspection: the Shepherd comes from beyond the wanderer's resources and bears it home. The coin prevents *lost* from meaning *worthless*: the sovereign image grounds the search even while cleansing remains necessary. Both end in convoked joy, and Luke explicitly names repentance.

### 4. Recovered life enters common offering and joy (*Off., Sec., Comm., Postcomm.*)

| Liturgical moment                 | Established movement                                                                                                                                          | Source-grounded control                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Offertory — trust                 | Psalm 9 turns those who know God's name toward trust, praise in Zion, and remembrance of the afflicted.                                                       | The found person does not become self-enclosed; received mercy opens an ecclesial voice toward other sufferers.                 |
| Secret — sanctification           | Personal <i>Respite in me</i> becomes ecclesial <i>Respite . . . munera</i> ; gifts are to be received for believers' salvation with enduring sanctification. | Irenaeus and Cyril of Jerusalem illuminate oblation and sanctified reception without supplying authorship for the Roman prayer. |
| Communion — shared joy            | Luke 15:10 places angelic joy over one repenting sinner on the communicants' lips.                                                                            | Cyril and Gregory require the hearer to rejoice at another's restoration; sacramental joy remains joined to repentance.         |
| Postcommunion — continuing effect | Holy things already received are asked to vivify and prepare the cleansed for everlasting mercy.                                                              | Reception is neither a trophy nor a self-completing act; divine gift continues as purification, life, and preparation.          |

#### Four guardrails — recoverable at a glance

- **Mercy is not indifference.** Luke's joy is joy over repentance under the just and patient Judge.
- **Grace is not passivity.** The seeker acts first; the found person repents, resists, offers, and receives.
- **Dignity is not self-restoration.** The image grounds the search; incarnation, Cross, illumination, and cleansing accomplish recovery.
- **Reception is not automatic.** Secret and Postcommunion remain petitions.

# Source-Grounded Exposition

## The Gospel’s controversy: mercy and false justice (*Gosp., Comm.*)

Luke first names the conflict: publicans and sinners draw near to hear Jesus, while Pharisees and scribes murmur because he receives and eats with them. The parables answer an accusation about Christ’s table-fellowship. They therefore reveal both the seeker’s character and the hearer’s possible resistance.

| Witness                        | Direct locus                                            | Exegetical emphasis                                                                                                                                                                          | Boundary to retain                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>St. Cyril of Alexandria</b> | <i>Commentary on Luke</i> , Homily 106, on Luke 15:1–10 | Christ receives those who approach because he is the saving physician. The accusers make mercy itself an accusation; Christ answers by requiring them to share the joy caused by repentance. | Cyril does not turn welcome into approval of sin. The movement is approach, healing, repentance, and joy.                                                 |
| <b>St. Gregory the Great</b>   | <i>Forty Gospel Homilies</i> , Homily 34                | True justice pities; false justice disdains. Converted sinners may love with unusual ardor because memory of their wandering intensifies gratitude.                                          | Gregory expressly avoids making every penitent superior to every person who remained just. His contrast diagnoses dispositions, not a mechanical ranking. |
| <b>Tertullian</b>              | <i>On Patience</i> , 12, receiving Luke 15              | Divine patience goes after one sheep and bears it; impatience would have despised the one for the sake of the many. Patience is active pursuit, not mere delay.                              | This is an early ascetical reception of the parable, not commentary on the Alleluia or on this Roman formulary.                                           |

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| <b>St. Cyril — the physician at the contested table</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Homily 106 treats the sinners’ willingness to hear as the opening received by the Savior’s gentleness. Christ’s condescension has a medicinal end: he does not become a participant in their disorder but makes his presence a means of rescue. The murmurers fail because they protect a reputation for exactness against the restoration the Law’s Lord desires. |
| <b>St. Gregory — compassion as the test of justice</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Gregory’s concise antithesis—true justice has compassion, false justice has disdain—does not suspend judgment. It identifies the just, strong, and patient Judge of the Alleluia as the source of mercy and exposes comparison without charity as counterfeit righteousness.                                                                                       |

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| <b>Mercy has a definite shape</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| The Gospel does not oppose justice to indifference. The Shepherd finds; the sinner repents; heaven rejoices. Mercy’s initiative makes conversion possible, and conversion discloses rather than purchases mercy. The Pharisaic error is not zeal for holiness as such, but refusal of the holy joy proper to a sinner’s restoration. |

## The Shepherd, the shoulders, and the home (*Gosp., Comm.*)

The first parable is deliberately disproportionate: one is missing, and the seeker refuses to treat that loss as negligible. Patristic interpretation enlarges the one without erasing Luke’s direct appeal to each sinner.

| Patristic movement                               | Textual ground                                                                                                                                                                      | Theological contribution                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>One sheep as fallen humanity</b>              | Gregory, Homily 34, reads the hundred as the fullness of rational creation, the ninety-nine as the angelic hosts remaining above, and the one as humanity wandering through sin.    | The Shepherd's descent is not a minor adjustment to an otherwise complete world. In the one human nature, the whole race is sought.                    |
| <b>The shoulders as assumed nature and Cross</b> | Gregory connects the carrying to Christ's assumption of human nature and bearing of sin; Ambrose, <i>Exposition of Luke</i> VII.208–210, makes the shoulders the arms of the Cross. | Recovery rests on Christ's labor. The sheep does not climb back by autonomous strength; the Incarnate and Crucified bears it home.                     |
| <b>One body in Adam and Christ</b>               | Ambrose can speak of the single sheep corporately: humanity was lost in Adam and is gathered in Christ.                                                                             | Personal repentance belongs inside a common human wound and a common ecclesial restoration. Individual concern and corporate salvation are not rivals. |
| <b>Friends and neighbors</b>                     | Gregory identifies the rejoicing circle with the angelic hosts; Ambrose likewise places restored humanity amid heavenly joy.                                                        | The Communion antiphon is not decorative sentiment. Eucharistic assembly rehearses the communion into which the sinner is carried.                     |

#### St. Ambrose — one saving work, three parables

In VII.207–212 Ambrose reads the lost sheep, coin, and son as a threefold remedy. He associates the Father, Christ, and the Church with receiving, carrying, and searching, while preserving the unity of the divine work. His shoulder imagery identifies the Cross as the form of the Shepherd's burden-bearing love.

#### How to handle the numbers

The Fathers' hundred and ninety-nine are theological figures of fullness and angelic communion, not a census of saved and lost persons. Nor does one sinner make salvation private: Luke's singular protects the irreducible value of the person, while Gregory and Ambrose show the one human nature borne home in Christ.

### The drachma: three searches within the house (*Gosp.*, *Comm.*)

The second parable repeats the sequence—loss, initiative, finding, convoked joy—but changes the field. The coin is not roaming outside; it is hidden within a house and bears an image whose value remains even when obscured. Gregory, Ambrose, and Gregory of Nyssa use those features differently.

| Witness                                     | Woman and lamp                                                                                                                                                                                 | Coin and house                                                                                                            | Distinctive result                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>St. Gregory the Great, Homily 34</b>     | The woman signifies divine Wisdom; the lamp is the manifestation of divinity in the earthen vessel of Christ's flesh. Sweeping names the searching disturbance by which conscience is exposed. | Fallen humanity lies hidden in the house of the world, bearing the Creator's stamp but obscured by sin.                   | Incarnation illuminates; searching grace makes the hidden image visible and restores it to heavenly fellowship. |
| <b>St. Ambrose, <i>Luke</i> VII.211–212</b> | The woman can signify the Church actively searching with the lamp.                                                                                                                             | The drachma bears the sovereign's image and belongs to the Church's treasure. Human dignity is received, not self-minted. | Ecclesial proclamation seeks what belongs to the King and summons the recovered person toward the Father.       |

| Witness                                              | Woman and lamp                                                                                   | Coin and house                                                                                | Distinctive result                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>St. Gregory of Nyssa, <i>On Virginity</i>, 12</b> | The lamp becomes reason illumined for an inward search; the house is the person's interior life. | The royal image has been covered by the accumulated dirt of disordered life, not annihilated. | The soul searches its faculties, uncovers the image, and calls the ordered powers of the soul to rejoice. |

*Source status.* Gregory and Ambrose expound Luke 15 directly. Gregory of Nyssa reuses the parable in an ascetical account of self-knowledge. The three readings are compatible levels of reception, but they should not be collapsed: divine Wisdom, the Church, and the searching soul are not interchangeable subjects in the Fathers' arguments.

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| <b>Outside and inside</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| The sheep prevents repentance from becoming mere introspection: the Shepherd comes from beyond the wanderer's resources. The drachma prevents lost from meaning worthless: the King's likeness remains the ground of the search. Together they describe rescue as pursuit, illumination, cleansing, and restored communion. |

## Repentance and the enlargement of joy (*Gosp.*, *Off.*, *Comm.*)

| Movement                                     | Patristic precision                                                                                                                                                                                                | Liturgical placement                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Mourning becomes changed life</b>         | Gregory defines repentance by joining grief over evil already done to refusal to repeat what must be grieved.                                                                                                      | Luke's explicit sinner doing penance governs the Communion's joy; reception cannot be detached from conversion.                            |
| <b>Memory becomes ardor</b>                  | Gregory notes that some converts love more intensely because they remember the danger from which they were rescued.                                                                                                | The Offertory's trust and praise are the found person's gratitude, not a boast over those who did not visibly wander.                      |
| <b>Private recovery becomes common feast</b> | Augustine, <i>Confessions</i> VIII.3–4, applies Luke 15 to Victorinus's conversion and asks why the whole Church rejoiced so publicly. A widely known return naturally enlarges the circle that receives the news. | Greater publicity explains the breadth of communal joy; it does not make a prominent convert more valuable before God than an obscure one. |
| <b>Angelic joy corrects human comparison</b> | Cyril and Gregory require the hearer to rejoice at the good accomplished in another.                                                                                                                               | The Communion makes the assembly sing the answer the murmurers withheld.                                                                   |

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| <b>St. Augustine — Victorinus inside Luke's feast</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Augustine does not cite the parables as ornament. In <i>Confessions</i> VIII he uses their logic to interpret the Church's solemn delight when Victorinus professes the faith publicly: one recovered life becomes a good shared by many. Augustine immediately guards the analogy by denying that wealth or fame makes one soul preferable to a poor person's soul. |

### Grace and response remain braided

The seeker acts first and until the lost is found. Yet Luke names repentance, Peter commands humility and resistance, and the altar asks for sanctification. Patristic praise of prevenient mercy does not make the recovered person inert; moral exhortation does not make the sinner his own shepherd.

## Entrusted care and sober resistance (*Ep., Grad., All.*)

First Peter 5:6–11 contains a tightly ordered sequence. Humility places the Christian under God’s mighty hand; care is cast upon him because he cares; sobriety recognizes a real adversary; resistance is made in faith and in solidarity with the suffering brotherhood; God himself restores, strengthens, and establishes.

| Apostolic act                     | Its ground                                               | Error excluded                                | Liturgical echo                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Humble yourselves</b>          | God’s mighty hand will exalt in due time                 | Humility as self-erasure or despair           | The Introit discloses poverty to a God asked to look and pity.                        |
| <b>Cast all care upon him</b>     | He has care of you                                       | Anxious control or irresponsible passivity    | The Gradual sings Psalm 54: <i>Iacta cogitatum tuum in Domino.</i>                    |
| <b>Be sober and watch</b>         | The devil seeks someone to devour                        | Naive denial of spiritual danger              | The solitary person of the Introit is gathered into a suffering brotherhood.          |
| <b>Resist, steadfast in faith</b> | The same sufferings are borne throughout the brotherhood | Isolated heroism or surrender to fear         | The Offertory turns the recovered person toward trust, seeking, praise, and the poor. |
| <b>Endure in hope</b>             | The God of all grace will perfect and establish          | Treating present affliction as the final word | The Postcommunion asks that holy things give life and prepare for everlasting mercy.  |

### St. Augustine — same-psalm exegesis

In *Exposition on Psalm 54* (the page headed Psalm 55 in modern numbering), 23, Augustine directly explains the Gradual’s *Iacta cogitatum tuum*. The burden is not handed to another fragile human being as though that person were the final support; the self and its care are entrusted to the Creator who made and sustains it. Applying that exposition to 1 Peter’s adjacent command is a documented scriptural resonance, not Augustine’s commentary on the Epistle.

### Tertullian — patience is pursuit

*On Patience* 12 sets the patient Shepherd against the impatience that would despise one lost sheep. This corrects a passive reading of the Alleluia’s *patiens*: divine patience seeks, bears, and restores, while Christian patience remains sober and steadfast under the same God.

### The predator is not the Sunday’s deepest actor

The devil seeks in order to consume; Christ seeks in order to carry home. Vigilance is urgent because danger is real, but hope is rational because the God of all grace has promised the last verbs: restore, strengthen, and establish.

## Gifts looked upon, believers sanctified (*Int., Sec., Postcomm.*)

### The Secret in its identified witnesses

**1962 Latin — printed witness ends at *in unitate*:** *Respice, Domine, múnera supplicántis Ecclesiæ: et salúti credéntium perpétua sanctificatióne suménda concéde. Per Dóminum nostrum Iesum Christum, Fílium tuum: Qui tecum vivit et regnat in unitate.*

**1925 historical English — abbreviated conclusion retained:** Favourably regard, we beseech Thee, O Lord, the offerings of Thy suppliant church: and grant that, hallowed for evermore by Thee, to Thy faithful receiving them, they may avail unto salvation. Through our Lord.



| Latin hinge                          | Grammatical force                                                             | Place in the Sunday's movement                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Respice, Domine</i>               | An imperative asking for God's attentive and favorable regard                 | The Introit's personal <i>Respice in me</i> reaches the altar as the Church's <i>Respice . . . munera</i> . The sought sinner is incorporated into a supplicating offerer. |
| <i>munera supplicantis Ecclesiae</i> | The gifts of the supplicating Church are the object of the divine gaze        | The prayer is ecclesial, not a private transaction; the Church offers while still begging.                                                                                 |
| <i>saluti credentium</i>             | A dative of end or advantage: for the salvation of believers                  | The gifts' requested fruit is personal and corporate salvation, not visible success or possession.                                                                         |
| <i>perpetua sanctificatione</i>      | An ablative naming the enduring sanctification with which reception is joined | Sanctification is divine action, not a quality the gifts or offerers manufacture independently.                                                                            |
| <i>sumenda concede</i>               | The gerundive agrees with <i>munera</i> : grant the gifts to be received      | <i>sumenda</i> anticipates the Postcommunion's <i>sumpta</i> : what is petitioned before the canon is confessed after reception.                                           |

#### St. Irenaeus — doctrinal illumination of oblation and reception

*Against Heresies* IV.18.1–5 teaches that the Church offers from God's own creation, that acceptance glorifies the offerer rather than supplying a divine need, and that Eucharistic bread receives a heavenly reality. Bodies nourished by it are therefore not destined for annihilation but for resurrection. Irenaeus does not comment on this Secret; he supplies doctrinal control for its movement from ecclesial gifts to sanctification and salvation.

#### St. Cyril of Jerusalem — sanctified gifts and holy reception

*Mystagogical Catechesis* 5 (Catechetical Lecture 23), especially 7 and 19–21, describes the invocation of the Holy Spirit upon the gifts, the proclamation of holy things for the holy, and the communicant's reverent reception. This is direct mystagogical teaching from a different local rite, not evidence for the Roman prayer's authorship. It illuminates why sanctification and reception belong together without making reception automatic or morally indifferent.

#### Four verbal threads through the formulary

- *Respice in me* becomes *Respice . . . munera*: the person under mercy enters the offering Church.
- The Collect's *sperantium* and the Secret's *credentium* hold hope and faith within God's protection.
- *perpetua sanctificatione* opens into the Postcommunion's *Sancta tua*: sanctification is received in holy things, not reduced to an inward idea.
- *sumenda* becomes *sumpta*: petition before reception becomes thanksgiving and a new petition for vivification afterward.

These links are textual observations within the formulary. The patristic witnesses illuminate them; they do not establish a reconstructed history of composition.

### Sacramental completion: joy, life, and everlasting mercy (*Int., Off., Sec., Comm., Post-comm.*)

The Communion repeats Luke 15:10 rather than choosing an unrelated sacramental verse. The assembly receives while singing heaven's joy over repentance. The Postcommunion then refuses to let joy remain a momentary emotion: the holy things received are asked to vivify, purify, and prepare the faithful for mercy without end.

| Moment               | Change of subject                                                     | Sacramental consequence                                                            |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Introit</b>       | The isolated sufferer asks God to look upon him.                      | Need is brought into truthful presence before God.                                 |
| <b>Gospel</b>        | Christ reveals the Shepherd and Wisdom who seek until they find.      | Divine initiative judges both despair and contempt.                                |
| <b>Offertory</b>     | Those who know God's name trust, seek, praise, and remember the poor. | The recovered person acquires an ecclesial voice and concern for other sufferers.  |
| <b>Secret</b>        | The supplicating Church asks God to look upon her gifts.              | Personal rescue becomes common oblation ordered to believers' salvation.           |
| <b>Communion</b>     | The Church sings the angels' joy over one sinner repenting.           | The murmurer's gaze is replaced by a received, heavenly pattern of desire.         |
| <b>Postcommunion</b> | The Church speaks as those who have received holy things.             | The gift is asked to give life now and prepare the purified for everlasting mercy. |

## Exploratory Proposals

*The proposals below are exploratory AI-generated syntheses of the appointed propers. They are attributed to none of the cited authorities and make no claim about the formulary's historical compositional intent; each proposal states its principal limit or alternative.*

**Who seeks in order to consume, and who seeks in order to restore?** (*Ep., Gosp.*) First Peter's adversary prowls in search of someone to devour; Luke's shepherd and woman search until what was lost is found. Placed together, the readings make lostness a field of opposed intentions: one search isolates life as prey, while the other refuses to abandon it as expendable. The comparison does not make the devil and Christ symmetrical, nor does it claim that Luke is interpreting First Peter; it asks what kind of seeker each text reveals.

**Can a burden be cast away because the burdened person is carried?** (*Ep., Grad., Gosp.*) The Epistle and Gradual tell the afflicted to cast care or burden upon the Lord; the Gospel's shepherd places the recovered sheep upon his own shoulders. The sequence permits a reversal: trust is not pretending to have no weight, but relinquishing the fantasy of solitary support to the one who bears the wanderer home. The verbal and visual correspondence is editorial rather than a claimed quotation, and it promises neither immediate relief from every affliction nor exemption from Peter's command to remain sober and resist.

**From asking to be seen toward learning to see.** (*Int., Sec., Comm.*) The Introit and Secret repeat *Respice*: first the afflicted person, then the Church's gifts, are placed beneath God's regard. The Communion voices the angels' joy. Their liturgical succession suggests a reversal in which the worshipper begins by asking God to look mercifully upon him and ends by learning how heaven looks upon another's repentance. The proposal does not turn angels into communicants or claim that the Secret's syntax describes vision; it links three distinct acts of attention.

**Does heaven's joy expose the last refuge of the murmurer?** (*Gosp., Comm.*) The Gospel contrasts the murmuring of those near Jesus with the joy of heaven over the recovered sinner, and the Communion places the latter response in the assembly's mouth. The antiphon may therefore test more than whether the worshipper admits a need for mercy: it asks whether mercy shown to another is received as common good or personal loss. Singing heaven's joy does not prove that envy has been overcome, and the antiphon remains first a proclamation of angelic joy rather than a psychological diagnosis of every communicant.

## Notable Quotables

- **Gradual — Exact quotation; Felix Mendelssohn, *Elijah*, Op. 70 (1846), No. 15 quartet.** “Cast thy burden upon the Lord” becomes a four-voice assurance, giving the Gradual's command and promise an especially memorable musical afterlife.
- **Gospel — Recognized allusion; Morley Callaghan, *More Joy in Heaven* (1937), title and central ex-convict plot.** The title echoes Luke 15:7 while the novel tests whether society can share heaven's joy over a man seeking rehabilitation after prison.

# References

## Primary and inherited sources

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- Dom Gaspar Lefebvre, O.S.B., *Daily Missal with Vespers for Sundays and Feasts* (Lophem near Bruges: St. Andrew’s Abbey; St. Paul, Minnesota: The E. M. Lohmann Co., 1925), p. 1062, edition scan; governing historical English witness for the Secret, including its abbreviated “Through our Lord.” conclusion. The 1925 wording is public domain in the United States by publication date and remains received third-party material outside the project’s CC BY grant; no worldwide rights status or current liturgical approval is claimed.
- Internet Archive, 1962 missal item and OCR locating aid; retrieval data, witness differences, and checksums: [propers/verified.md](#). The Secret is also indexed in the Corpus Orationum record.
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- St. Irenaeus, *Against Heresies* IV.18.1–5, oblation, Eucharist, and resurrection.
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## Biblical-historical orientation

- *New American Bible, Revised Edition*: introductions to Psalms, Luke, and 1 Peter; texts and notes for Psalms 7, 9, 25, and 55, Luke 15, and 1 Peter 5; USCCB online edition, accessed 2026-07-10.
- *Catholic Encyclopedia*: “Psalms”, “King David”, “Gospel of Saint Luke”, “Epistles of Saint Peter”, and “Chronology of the Life of Jesus Christ”; witnesses to traditional authorship, place, and chronology, consulted 2026-07-10.
- Septuagint/Vulgate titles and chapter context: Psalm 7, Psalm 9/10, Psalm 24 (modern 25), Psalm 54 (modern 55), Luke 15, and 1 Peter 5.

## Search Scope and Limitations

**Text.** All ten propers were collated with the 1962 typical-edition facsimile, pp. 380–382. **Historical orientation.** Six distinct direct biblical passages appear in canonical order; traditional composition metadata, Luke’s narrated setting, and historical alternatives are distinguished. **Direct reception.** Luke 15, Psalm 54, and explicit ascetical reuse of the parables. **Related illumination.** Oblation, sanctification, Eucharistic reception, and ecclesial joy. **Material limits.** Psalm origins and sites, Luke’s exact event and composition locations, and 1 Peter’s authorship and date remain disputed; no independent theological review or exhaustive manuscript, untranslated, subscription, or cultural-reception survey is claimed. **Full records.** [propers/verified.md](#); [research/scope.md](#).

## Generation Metadata

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